# Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the River Plate Room, Ajax Town Hall Monday, March 23, 2026

**Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:**
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

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|---|---|---|---|
| Present: | Deputy Mayor | - | S. Lee |
| | Regional Councillors | - | M. Crawford |
| | | - | J. Dies |
| | Councillors | - | R. Tyler Morin |
| | | - | N. Henry |
| | Mayor | - | S. Collier (exited at 2:20 p.m.) |
| Regrets: | Councillor | - | L. Bower |

## 1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Deputy Mayor Lee called the meeting to order at 1:02 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

## 2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

Motion to Suspend the Rules of Procedure

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the Rules of Procedure be suspended to waive the requirement for recorded votes on non-substantive items.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Henry, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee

Opposed: None

CARRIED
on 2/3rds

## 3. Adoption of the Minutes

### 3.1. Regular Meeting - February 17, 2026

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the minutes of the Regular Meeting of Council held on February 17, 2026 be adopted.

CARRIED

### 3.2. Special Meeting – March 2, 2026

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the minutes of the Special Meeting of Council held on March 2, 2026 be adopted.

CARRIED

## 4. Question Period

Deputy Mayor Lee invited questions on agenda items from those present.

## 5. Delegations, Presentations, and Public Meetings

### 5.1. Presentation: Degree Designation Recognition Ceremony

Deputy Mayor Lee noted that item 5.1 had been withdrawn.

### 5.2. Delegation: Save Soil Day

Shashank Reddy, Volunteer for Save Soil and Resident of Ajax, delivered a presentation related to Save Soil Day.

### 5.3. Public Meeting: Official Plan Amendment Application OPA26-A3 Zoning By-law Amendment Application Z5/26 190 Westney Road South

Pursuant to section 284.3 of the Municipal Act, 2001

Mayor Collier summarized the fundamental elements of the proposed by-laws.

Deputy Mayor Lee declared the meeting to be a public meeting and invited comments and questions from the public.

Joel Wittribel, Ajax resident, asked questions and expressed concerns related to the proposed development applications. Mayor Collier and Aaron Burridge, Fire Chief, responded to questions from the delegate.

Lisa Sklar, Ajax resident, asked questions related to the proposed development applications. Mayor Collier responded to questions from the delegate.

There being no further questions or comments from the public, Deputy Mayor Lee closed the public meeting.

Max Tarsky, Ledim Developments Ltd., owner/applicant, reviewed technical amendments to the proposed by-laws.

Council Members asked questions related to the proposed development applications. M. Tarsky and Mayor Collier, responded to questions from Council Members.

With the consent of Members present, items 11.2 and 11.3 were advanced in the order business.

## 11. By-laws

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That By-laws 34-2026 and 35-2026 be approved.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Henry, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee

Opposed: Regional Councillor Dies

CARRIED
on 1/3rd

# 5. Delegations, Presentations, and Public Meetings

## 5.4. Public Meeting: Zoning By-law Amendment Application Z4/26 Northeast Corner of Harwood Avenue South & Achilles Road

Pursuant to section 284.3 of the Municipal Act, 2001

Mayor Collier summarized the fundamental elements of the proposed by-law.

Deputy Mayor Lee declared the meeting to be a public meeting and invited comments and questions from the public.

Lisa Sklar, Ajax resident, expressed support for the proposed development application.

Heather Middleton, Ajax resident, expressed concerns related to the proposed development application. Mayor Collier responded to concerns raised by the delegate.

Leah White, Ajax resident, asked questions related to the proposed development application. Mayor Collier responded to questions from the delegate. Council Members asked questions related to the delegation. L. White responded to questions from Council Members.

Dennis Kovacsi, Ajax resident, asked questions related to the proposed development application.

Joe Modeste, Ajax resident, expressed support for the proposed development application.

Marla Walters, Ajax resident, expressed support for the proposed development application.

There being no further questions or comments from the public, Deputy Mayor Lee closed the public meeting.

With the consent of Members present, item 8.2 was advanced in the order business.

# 8. Departmental Reports

## 8.2. PSA-2026-05: Supportive Housing Project at Harwood Avenue South and Achilles Road

Kassandra Brownridge, Manager of Strategic Initiatives, reviewed the contents of the written report and recommendations contained therein. Council Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. Gary Muller, Director, Affordable Housing Development and Renewal, The Regional Municipality of Durham, Erin Valant, Director, Housing Services, The Regional Municipality of Durham, and K. Brownridge, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: S. Collier

1. That Council endorse the Supportive Housing Project proposed by the Region of Durham located at the northeast corner of Harwood Avenue South and Achilles Road;

2. That Council authorize the allocation of $500,000 from the Town's Housing Accelerator Fund (HAF) to the Region of Durham to support the delivery of the project, contingent upon approval by Regional Council and receipt of Build Canada Homes funding for the project;

3. That the CAO or their designate(s) be delegated the authority to negotiate and enter into an agreement with the Region of Durham to outline the terms and conditions of the use of the funding contribution from the Town;

4. That Council direct staff to continue working expeditiously with the Region of Durham and other stakeholders as required to advance the required approvals; and

5. That Council direct staff to support advocacy efforts by the Region of Durham to secure sustainable, long-term operational funding for supportive housing from the Province of Ontario.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Dies, Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Henry, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee

Opposed: None

CARRIED

With the consent of Members present, item 11.4 was advanced in the order business.

## 11. By-laws

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: S. Collier

That By-law 36-2026 be approved.

In Favour: Councillor Henry, Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee

Opposed: None

CARRIED
on 1/3rd

Council recessed at 2:20 p.m.

Council resumed at 2:27 p.m.

## 6. Correspondence

None.

## 7. Standing Committee Reports

### 7.1. Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report, March 2, 2026

None.

### 7.2. General Government Committee Report, March 9, 2026

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the recommendations from the General Government Committee Meeting of March 9, 2025 be adopted.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee

Opposed: Counicllor Henry

CARRIED

# 8. Departmental Reports

## 8.1. PSA-2026-04: Sponsorship and Advertising Asset Inventory

K. Brownridge reviewed the contents of the written report and recommendations contained therein. Council Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. K. Brownridge, Christie McLardie, Director of Public & Strategic Affairs, Chris Vida, Director of Recreation & Culture, and Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

1. That the Sponsorship & Advertising Asset Inventory & Valuation Report (ATT-1) be endorsed by Council in principle; and,

2. That any projects, initiatives, and resources identified therein for future years be considered as part of the annual budget process.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Henry, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee

Opposed: None

CARRIED

# 9. Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Councillor Members provided updates from the Region related to PRESTO account-based system updates and the tiny cabin communities pilot project.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of March 23, 2026 be received for information.

In Favour: Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Lee

Opposed: None

CARRIED

# 10. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

## 10.1. Affirming Freedom of Religious Expression and Supporting Residents Impacted by Bill 21

Councillor Henry and Regional Councillor Crawford introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: M. Crawford

Whereas the Town of Ajax is committed to upholding the rights, dignity, and safety of all residents, and to fostering a community where every individual feels a sense of belonging; and,

Whereas municipal advocacy is appropriate when provincial or national issues directly affect residents' sense of safety, belonging, or equality; and,

Whereas members of equity-deserving communities in Ajax, including Muslim, Jewish, Sikh, and other faith groups, have expressed fear, distress, and uncertainty regarding the broader implications of Quebec's Bill 21 (An Act Respecting the Laicity of the State); and

Whereas when an equity-deserving group expresses fear or distress arising from national or provincial legislation, this becomes a local issue that municipal councils have a responsibility to acknowledge; and

Whereas Bill 21 restricts individuals who wear religious symbols or attire, including hijabs, turbans, kippahs, crucifixes, and other expressions of faith, from holding certain public sector positions, with disproportionate impacts reported among Muslim women who wear the hijab; and

Whereas the symbolic impact of Bill 21 is being felt across Canada, including within Ajax, where residents have shared concerns about the precedent it sets for gender equality, religious freedom, and human rights; and

Whereas the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms guarantees freedom of conscience, religion, and expression, and municipalities across Canada have passed motions affirming these rights and condemning discrimination based on religious attire or symbols; and

Whereas Durham Regional Council, in January 2022, supported the national legal challenge to Bill 21, recognizing the harm it causes to residents who wear religious attire and the fear it creates within marginalized communities; and

Therefore be it resolved:

That the Town of Ajax affirms its support for the right of all women and all residents to express their religion freely through clothing, jewellery, or other forms of personal expression without discrimination; and

That the Town of Ajax expresses concern regarding the discriminatory impacts of Bill 21 on women and on freedom of religion and expression; and

That Council stands in solidarity with residents who feel fear or distress as a result of Bill 21 and reaffirms Ajax's commitment to being an inclusive and welcoming community for all; and

That a copy of this motion be sent to the Prime Minister of Canada, the Minister of Justice and Attorney General of Canada, the Premier of Ontario, the Ontario Minister of Citizenship and Multiculturalism, the Region of Durham, all Durham municipalities, and the province of Quebec; and

That this motion be shared publicly to reassure residents of Ajax that their rights and freedoms are supported and protected by their local government.

In Favour: Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee

Opposed: None

CARRIED

## 11. By-laws

Council Members asked questions regarding By-law 33-2026. A. Burridge responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That By-laws 33-2026 and 37-2026 to 38-2026 be approved.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Dies, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Henry, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee

Opposed: None

CARRIED

## 12. Notice of Motion

Councillor Henry provided notice of a future motion urging enhanced federal and provincial measures to prevent the exploitation of minors in organized theft, including stronger legal protections, increased resources, and expanded youth prevention programs.

## 13. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming community events and matters of community interest.

## 14. Confirming By-law

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: N. Henry

That By-law 39-2026 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its regular meeting held on March 23, 2026, be approved.

In Favour: Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Lee

Opposed: None

CARRIED

## 15. Adjournment

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: N. Henry

That the March 23, 2026 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (3:10 p.m.)

CARRIED

_____
Mayor and CEO

_____
Clerk